

INTRODUCTION TO PHOTOGRAPHY

VOCABULARY LIST

- Elements of photography: Successful photos rely on order, and the main elements that bring and emphasize order in a photograph's composition are: line, color, shape, contrast, emphasis, texture, and space.
- Line: Used in photographs to move your eye around the image, lead your eye to the focal point, create texture, pattern, and emphasis.
- Color: Used in photographs to create emphasis, variety, and interest.
- Shape: Used in photographs to create pattern, repetition, unity, and variety. Distinguishing shapes are shapes that are isolated and as a result, emphasized. Overlapping shapes creates repetition and a sense of unity in the photograph.
- Contrast: The arrangement of opposite elements (light vs. dark colors, rough vs. smooth textures, large vs. small shapes, etc.) in a piece so as to create visual interest, excitement and drama.
- Emphasis: Used to help bring your eye to the focal point. Emphasis can be created through positioning, focus, depth of field, and framing the subject matter.
- Texture: Used in photography to help different subjects stand out from each other, create unity and variety and add interest.
- Space: Used in photography to create a sense of depth, frame the subject matter, and help define the focal point.
- Elements of art: The building blocks of a work of art. The visual components of color, form, line, shape, space, texture, and value.
- Principles of design: describe the ways that artists use the elements of art in a work of art. Includes: balance, emphasis, movement, proportion, repetition, pattern, rhythm, contrast, unity, and variety.
- Composition: In the visual arts, composition is the placement or arrangement of visual elements in a work of art. The term composition means 'putting together' and can apply to any work of art, from music to writing to photography, that is arranged using conscious thought.
- Rules of composition: Guiding principles to help create successful photographs. Includes the rule of thirds, balancing elements, leading lines, viewpoint, inclusion and exclusion.

- Rules of thirds: Placing the focal point of the photograph in one of the third sections rather than directly in the center.
- Aperture: A part of a lens that controls the amount of light that enters the camera and as a result, the depth of field.
- F-stop/f-number: a camera setting corresponding to a particular f-number, which is determined by the ratio of focal length to the aperture diameter. The f-number represents the aperture setting.
- Depth of field: the distance between the nearest and the furthest objects that give an image judged to be in focus in a camera.
- Shutter speed: In photography, the length of time for which a shutter is open at a given setting.
- ISO: Can change the lightness and darkness of a photograph while capturing it. Low ISO numbers mean the image will be darker and crisper, high ISO numbers mean the image will be bright but more grainy.
- Manual mode: Full control over the digital camera settings. You are able to change the aperture, shutter speed, and ISO without the camera trying to interfere with the settings.
- Portrait photography: a photograph of a person or group of people that captures the personality of the subject by using effective lighting, backdrops, and poses.
- Directional lighting: lighting from just one direction to create contrast and drama.
- Ambient light: available light, before any other light sources are added, typically natural light.
- Soft-light: In-direct lighting.
- Environmental portrait: A portrait in which the background of the image gives context to the subject in the image.
- Double exposure: The combination of two images into one, with one image overlaid onto another at a lesser opacity.
- Photojournalism: A form of journalism that involves using photographs as a source for news media through publication or broadcast.
- Conceptual photography: Setting up and creating an image with a preconceived idea in mind. Creating a sense of a story in an image.